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"All the News That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, partly cloudy, less humid, light winds, high 79. **Tonight,** partly cloudy, low 63. **Tomorrow,** mix of clouds and sunshine, light winds, high 74. Weather map, Page A20.

VOL. CLXXV No. 60,998 © 2026 The New York Times Company SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 5, 2026 Prices in Canada may be higher $4.00

After 9 Days In Dark Hole, 2 See Daylight

Workers Are Rescued From Tunnel in Nepal

This article is by ***Mujib Mashal****,* ***Anupreeta Das****,* ***Laura Chung*** *and* ***Thomas Fuller****.*

RASUWA, Nepal — The rescuers heard voices. They crawled through a sludge-filled tunnel deep underground where employees of a hydroelectric plant in Nepal had been trapped for nine days.

"We are coming!" Lt. Col. Ganga Baral, one of the leaders of the operation, said he had called out. "Don't worry, the Nepali Army is coming."

On Friday morning, two mud-caked survivors were rescued from the tunnels and hoisted into the open air, an extraordinary moment captured on video and in photos by the army.

The improbable rescue provided a measure of hope a week and a half after a glacial collapse unleashed a tsunami of mud and boulders that killed more than 1,300 people in Nepal and Tibet and left thousands of others missing.

The men were rescued from a hydroelectric center buried so deeply in the detritus of the flood that engineers had to use satellite images to pinpoint its location amid the disfigured landscape.

Hirashova Maharjan, the wife of Kabir Maharjan, one of the workers rescued, described her husband as deeply disoriented after being airlifted to Kathmandu, the capital, for medical treatment.

"He didn't even recognize me," she said from the army hospital in Kathmandu. But his condition has since improved, she said.

"He is stable now," she said. "We're so happy. We are crying with happiness. Thank you to the army and to the government."

The raging floodwaters that erupted on Aug. 26 washed away roads, bridges and, in some cases, entire villages.

The two men were rescued from a tunnel in the Upper Trishuli 3A hydropower project. The body of a

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NAVESH CHITRAKAR/REUTERS

Rescue workers digging to enter a tunnel at a hydropower station in Rasuwa, Nepal, on Thursday, nine days after massive flooding.

Steinem Focused on Wins Despite Recent Blows

Upbeat View of Future Even With Growth of Anti-Feminism

By JULIE BOSMAN and RUTH GRAHAM

For decades, Gloria Steinem invited women into her Upper East Side apartment, a cozy space packed with mementos from her life as a crusading feminist. The women participated in her famous "talking circles," shared stories and talked political strategy.

And in recent years, after the fall of Roe v. Wade and the election of Donald Trump, some of the attendees arrived with the expectation that their host would feel as despairing as they did.

"People would walk in and say, 'God, she's going to be so depressed,'" said Cindi Leive, an executive producer of "Dear Ms.," a documentary on the magazine Ms. Steinem co-founded. "This woman is seeing everything she's worked for crumble all around her."

But people who were close to Ms. Steinem, who died on Wednesday at 92, said that she was more focused on counting victories than defeats, even in her later years when feminism was dealt a series of bruising setbacks. As reality shows and social media influencers glorifying traditional gender roles help shape popular culture, and access to contraceptives and abortion was abruptly curtailed in many states, Ms. Steinem held a longer view, her friends said.

After she made speeches at college campuses and conferences, she would come back home with stories of the progress that she was seeing around the country, a continuation of the transformations that she helped usher in beginning in the 1970s.

"She felt that battles were unfinished," said Letty Cottin Pogrebin, who with Ms. Steinem and other women founded Ms. magazine. "But she focused me and everybody else on the future. She really didn't want to give the tradwives and the manosphere the credit for being long-lasting."

The morning after Ms. Steinem's death, tributes from admirers poured in from around the

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In Venezuela, U.S. Ignores Oilman's Past

This article is by ***Simon Romero****,* ***Julie Turkewitz****,* ***Edward Wong*** *and* ***Alan Feuer****.*

Prosecutors in Spain targeted the Venezuelan oilman Alejandro Betancourt in one money laundering inquiry. Swiss authorities investigated him in another. Both countries requested his extradition from Britain, where Mr. Betancourt lives in a 14-bedroom country estate, and British authorities arrested him less than a year ago, barring him from traveling abroad.

All of it hardly mattered.

As part of the Trump administration's takeover of Venezuela's oil industry, the United States is forming an extraordinary partnership with Mr. Betancourt. Under the arrangement, the Pentagon could seek to take a large stake in his company, a deal that defies easy comparison in recent American history, oil analysts say.

That would make Mr. Betancourt the main partner of the Trump administration as it pushes not just to control the sale of Venezuela's oil, but to own a chunk of it directly. And it would place Mr. Betancourt at the core of Venezuela's deepening transformation from a sovereign nation

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GAINS IN HIRING SHOW STRENGTH OF U.S. ECONOMY

162,000 JOBS CREATED

Growth Is Broad Even as Inflation Continues to Strain Wallets

By SYDNEY EMBER

Businesses in August shook off uncertainty related to higher gas prices, tariffs and artificial intelligence, unleashing an unexpected wave of hiring that affirmed the labor market's health.

Employers added 162,000 jobs on a seasonally adjusted basis last month, the Labor Department reported on Friday, and the unemployment rate held steady at 4.1 percent.

Job gains for June and July were revised upward by 55,000, bringing the average increase over the past three months to just over 70,000.

And while the health care sector fueled much of the employment growth last year, last month's gains touched even sectors that had appeared troubled, evidence of strength in the broader economy.

The zesty employment figures come at a time of broader economic resilience, marked by strong corporate profits and vigorous capital investments spurred by A.I. Consumer spending, buoyed by a roaring stock market, has stayed resilient despite higher gas prices brought on by the war in Iran. The manufacturing and services sectors are expanding at a moderate pace.

"It's a very good report; I can't emphasize that enough," said Blerina Uruci, the chief U.S. economist at T. Rowe Price. "And it perhaps shows that financial conditions more broadly are not that tight."

Much of the data in the report flashed similarly encouraging signals. The share of people working or looking for work ticked up, reversing a monthslong skid. A separate measure that takes into account people who have been discouraged from looking for jobs or want more hours also fell to its lowest level in more than a year, indicating that many people were able to find at least some work.

The average workweek lengthened slightly to 34.4 hours, as employers stretched workers to meet demand.

Puncturing the rosy notes was wage growth, which continued to cool in August. Growth in average hourly earnings fell to 3.1 percent over the past year, the slowest pace since the depths of the pandemic and lower than the inflation rate.

The tepid wage growth supports the Federal Reserve's view

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Jury Deadlock Leads to Mistrial in Clancy Case

Murder Charges Stay — a 2nd Trial Is Possible

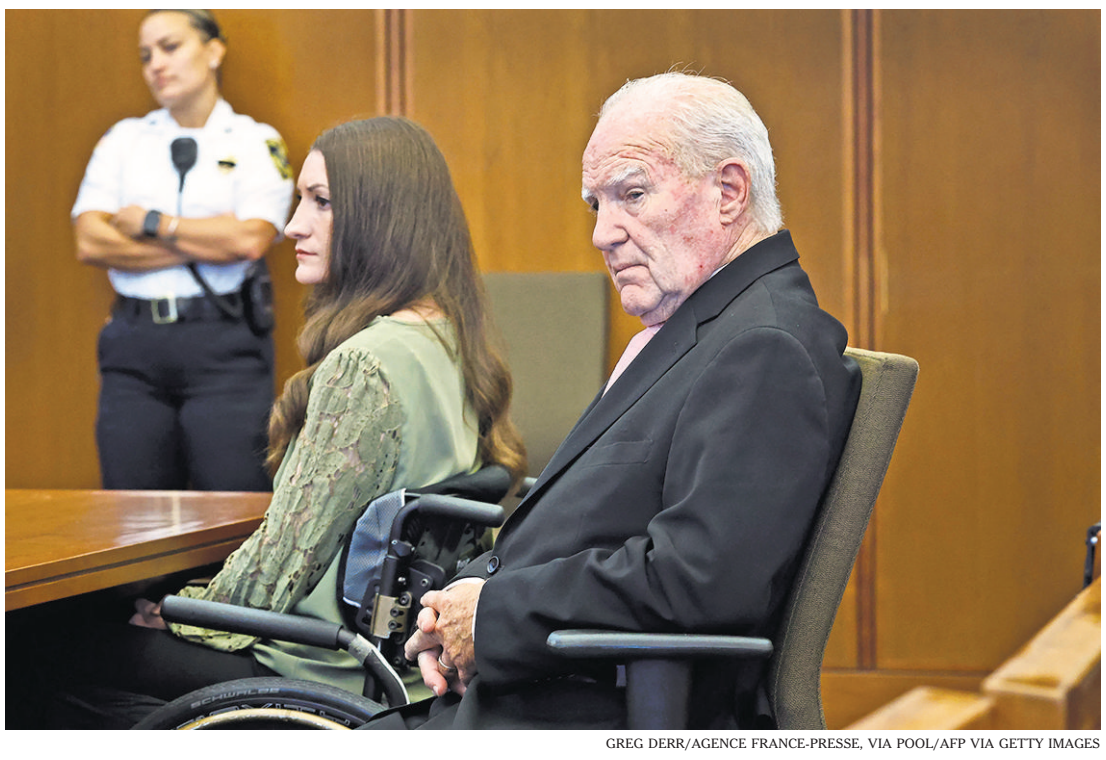
By JENNA RUSSELL and JACEY FORTIN

PLYMOUTH, Mass. — A shocking triple-murder case that spurred a national conversation about punishment and mothers' mental health ended in a mistrial on Friday, after a flurry of courtroom drama, an emergency appeal to the top court in Massachusetts and a note from jurors saying they remained deadlocked "with a heavy heart."

The jury could not reach a verdict on the charges against Lindsay Clancy, who strangled her three young children in January 2023.

After a monthlong trial and roughly 38 hours of deliberations over seven days, a single juror was holding out against 11 others who believed Ms. Clancy should be acquitted. Other jurors accused that juror of acknowledging doubt about Ms. Clancy's criminal responsibility, but refusing to apply the legal standard. The judge declined to side with either the 11 for acquittal or the lone vote for conviction, declaring a hung jury.

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GREG DERR/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE, VIA POOL/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Lindsay Clancy with the lead lawyer on her defense team, Kevin Reddington, in court on Friday.

Confident Iran May Be Willing To Escalate War

By JULIAN E. BARNES and DUSTIN VOLZ

WASHINGTON — Iran has grown more confident in its ability to attack targets in the Middle East and appears determined to continue the conflict for months to frustrate the United States, according to U.S. intelligence reports in recent weeks.

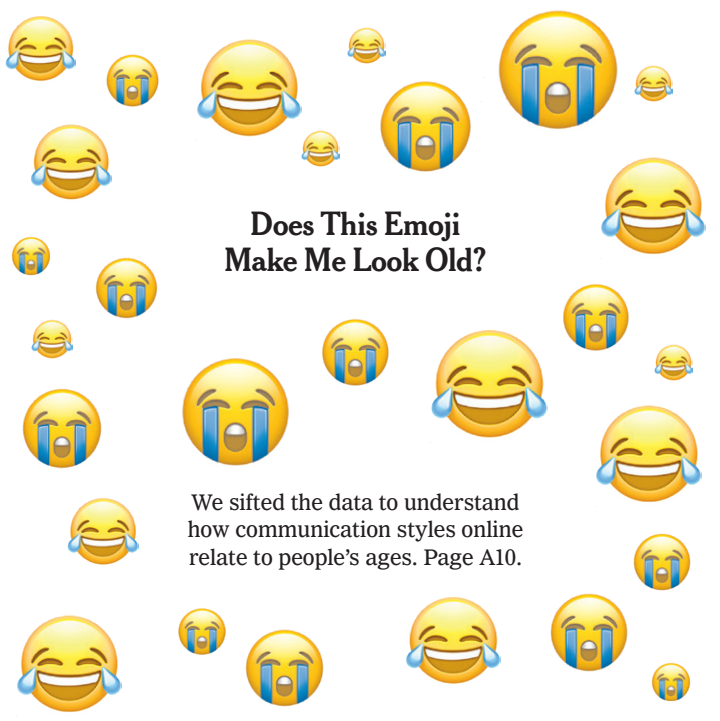
In many respects, the assessments reflect what has been observable on the ground as fighting erupted again after a period of relative calm. In the past week, Iran targeted ships in the Strait of Hormuz and American troops in the region, and U.S. forces struck inside Iran, killing military personnel and civilians.

The new exchanges have been limited so far. But the intelligence reports, according to people who have read them, suggest that Iran's hard-line government might be contemplating a significant escalation.

Iran has emerged from months of the on-again, off-again war with a far better understanding of its military strengths and is more sure of its capabilities, according to officials briefed on the intelligence.

The reports, some current and former officials said, suggest that any agreement to fully end the

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Worries of Russian Sabotage
Europe's options are limited in responding to an unnerving series of plots and provocations. But the odds of unpredictable consequences are rising. PAGE A6

Gold Rush Out of U.S.
The Netherlands is the second European nation this year to announce the transfer of reserves. PAGE A7

SPORTS B7-10

Still Basking, Still Hungry
A survey indicated that fans of the defending F.B.S. champion, Indiana, expected more such runs. PAGE B7

BUSINESS B1-6

Watchdogs on a Short Leash
Researchers investigating how OpenAI's A.I. agents were able to break into Hugging Face's infrastructure issued a 91-page report but weren't allowed to look at the episode's full scope. PAGE B1

A Print Era Is Ending
The Saturday Evening Post, famous for Jack London stories and Norman Rockwell art, will continue online. PAGE B5



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The Billion-Dollar Midterms
Ultrawealthy Republicans and tech industry titans, who dominate the list of the top 20 political donors, plan to spend lavishly on races. PAGE A12

Biodefense Pact Criticized
A Pentagon partnership with the National Institutes of Health has raised alarm among Democrats. PAGE A14

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Divorcée Summer Weekend
Some women are embracing a social media trend of indulgence and, maybe, empowerment. PAGE C8

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Her Wigs and Glitter Inspired
Dolly Parton was a steadfast advocate for her L.G.B.T.Q. fans, standing up for those who have been marginalized and making them feel understood, even if they had never met her. PAGE C1

Mission to Save Old Filmstrips
A handful of academics and enthusiasts around the world are racing to collect a media format that originated in the 1920s, aiming to preserve a visual history they say is being lost. PAGE C1

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Samuel Earle PAGE A18

THIS WEEKEND

